

Reza Kahibavil

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SUMMARY

Quantitative finance professional and Ph.D. candidate in Finance with 6+ years of experience in portfolio management, equity valuation, and empirical asset-pricing research on large-scale panel data (CRSP, TAQ). Founded and managed a financial advisory firm directing 100+ individual and 20 institutional portfolios and a team of fundamental analysts. Current research examines return predictability and extreme-return anomalies, using Python, R, MATLAB, and SAS to build and backtest empirical models.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Candidate, Finance, Old Dominion University Norfolk, VA	2024 – Present
M.S., Financial Engineering and Risk Management, University of Isfahan International	2017 – 2021
B.S., Industrial Management, Shahid Beheshti University International	2012 – 2016

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Programming & Tools: Python, R, MATLAB, SAS, Stata, EViews, SPSS, Microsoft Excel

Quantitative Methods: Asset Pricing, Portfolio Analysis, Risk Management, Time-Series Analysis, Return Forecasting, Financial Econometrics

Data & Analytics: Large-scale panel data (CRSP, TAQ, COMPUSTAT, IBES, Bloomberg); Equity Valuation, Financial Statement Analysis, Earnings Forecasting

Certifications: CFA Level III Candidate, Passed Level II (2026); Bloomberg Market Concepts (2024)

EXPERIENCE

Old Dominion University Norfolk, VA	2024 – Present
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Graduate Research Assistant

Retail Investor Participation & Lottery-Like Stock Mispricing

2026

- Constructed measures of systematic retail participation from weekly Robinhood holdings data, isolating persistent ownership and flow dynamics from attention-driven trading.
- Found that systematic retail participation predicts positive future returns independent of the MAX anomaly; accepted for presentation, Southern Finance Association 2026, under review at the Journal of Banking & Finance.

Expected vs. Unexpected Extreme Returns and the MAX Anomaly

2026

- Decompose extreme stock returns into expected and unexpected components to test their differing implications for subsequent returns, using cross-sectional asset-pricing methods on large-scale return panels (CRSP/TAQ).
- Accepted for presentation, Southern Finance Association 2026; under review at the Review of Finance.

Additional Research

- Idiosyncratic Volatility:** re-examining whether alternative volatility measures explain the IVOL puzzle.
- Extreme Return Predictability:** conditional predictive power of extreme returns.
- Cross-Listing & Market Integration:** stock returns and integration effects for cross-listed securities.
- Sports Betting & Speculative Trading:** triple difference-in-differences design to link legalized sports betting to speculative stock behavior.

Instructor, Department of Finance

- FIN 323- Introduction to Financial Management** | In-class & Online

2025 - 2026

ARKA Mohaseb Sahand | International

2018 – 2021

Founder & Portfolio Manager

- Founded and managed a financial advisory firm specializing in portfolio management, equity valuation, and financial data analysis for individual and institutional investors.
- Managed 100+ individual and 20 institutional investment portfolios, leading a team of fundamental analysts on equity valuation, earnings forecasting, and stock-performance analysis.
- Built a structured financial data center integrating market data, earnings forecasts, and valuation models to support investment research.

Arman Ati Financial Group | International

2019

Research Collaborator

- Evaluated informational and operational efficiency of the Iranian stock market using historical pricing, trading volume, and earnings data; contributed to empirical tests of weak-form and semi-strong-form market efficiency.
- Collected, cleaned, and analyzed data using financial databases and modeling tools.

Jaber Ebne Hayyan Pharmaceutical Company | International

Summers 2016 – 2017

Finance & Inventory Intern

Supported financial reporting, cost analysis, budget monitoring, and variance analysis; financial transaction and inventory-control procedures.

AWARDS

- Old Dominion University, 2026 – Graduate Summer Award Program (GSAP) Research Award (\$4,000)
- University of Isfahan, 2021 – Ranked 2nd Among Financial Engineering Graduates
- University of Isfahan Team, 2018–2019 – Stock Market Stars League (Ranked 2nd of 34 Universities Nationwide)

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Yung, K., Kahibavil, R., Li, S., & Amidi, A. (2026). "International Evidence on the Relationship Between Financial Literacy and Corporate Cash Holdings." Journal of Corporate Accounting & Finance.
- Haghighi Zadeh, R., Kahibavil, R., & Safari, N. (2026). "Do Retail Investors Drive Lottery-Like Stock Mispricing?" Working paper; under review, Journal of Banking & Finance.
- Haghighi Zadeh, R., Kahibavil, R., & Safari, N. (2026). "Expected vs. Unexpected Extremes: The Origins of the MAX Anomaly?" Working paper; under review, Review of Finance.